Pakistan Real Estate Market Analysis

Insight Summary Report

Zameen.com Dataset | 191,393 Property Listings | 5 Cities

1. Executive Summary

This report presents the key findings from an exploratory data analysis of 191,393 property listings from Zameen.com, Pakistan's largest real estate portal. The dataset covers five major cities (Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad, Rawalpindi, and Faisalabad) with listings from August 2018 to August 2019. The analysis reveals significant regional pricing disparities, strong growth in digital listing activity, and clear patterns in property preferences that can guide investment decisions.

2. Dataset at a Glance

Metric	Value
Total Listings	191,393
Cities Covered	5 (Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad, Rawalpindi, Faisalabad)
Date Range	August 2018 - August 2019
Property Types	7 (House, Flat, Upper Portion, Lower Portion, Room, Farm House, Penthouse)
Listing Purposes	For Sale (127,018) and For Rent (64,375)
Mean Price	PKR 16.4 Million
Median Price	PKR 7.3 Million
Missing Values	agency (47,379) and agent (47,380) - filled with "Unknown"
Area Column	Mixed units (Kanal/Marla) - standardized to Marla

3. Key Findings

3.1 Market Composition

Houses dominate the market, accounting for 62.1% of all listings (118,915), followed by Flats at 21.0% (40,157). Upper Portions and Lower Portions make up 15.8% combined. Niche segments like Penthouses

(399) and Farm Houses (725) represent less than 1% of the market.

Karachi leads in volume with 60,484 listings (31.6%), closely followed by Lahore at 58,736 (30.7%). Islamabad accounts for 21.0%, Rawalpindi 12.0%, and Faisalabad 4.7%.

3.2 Pricing Insights

Property prices are **highly right-skewed** -- the mean (PKR 16.4M) is more than double the median (PKR 7.3M), indicating that a small number of ultra-premium properties pull the average upward. A log transformation reveals the underlying distribution is approximately normal.

City	Median Sale Price	Median Overall Price	Sale %
Islamabad	PKR 16.0M	PKR 240K	42.8%
Lahore	PKR 16.0M	PKR 11.5M	77.0%
Karachi	PKR 12.5M	PKR 8.5M	77.2%
Rawalpindi	PKR 11.0M	PKR 3.7M	55.6%
Faisalabad	PKR 9.5M	PKR 4.5M	57.2%

Note: Islamabad's low overall median (PKR 240K) is because 57.2% of its listings are rentals. When filtered to sale-only listings, Islamabad and Lahore are tied as the most expensive cities at PKR 16M median.

3.3 Price Drivers

Correlation analysis reveals that **number of bedrooms** has the strongest positive correlation with price (r = 0.303), followed by **number of bathrooms** (r = 0.219) and **area in marla** (r = 0.100). The relatively low area correlation suggests that location and property condition matter more than raw size alone.

3.4 Temporal Patterns

The dataset shows a **massive jump in listing activity** from 2018 (12,309 listings for the partial year) to 2019 (179,084 listings). **July is the peak month** for new listings (88,069), which may reflect seasonal factors such as pre-monsoon activity or fiscal year cycles. The growth trajectory suggests rapid digitization of Pakistan's real estate market.

3.5 High-Value Market Growth

Defining high-value properties as those above the 75th percentile (PKR 18M+), all three major cities saw explosive growth. Lahore grew from 843 to 19,705 high-value listings, Karachi from 974 to 14,586, and Islamabad from 392 to 7,356. This reflects both market growth and increased platform adoption.

3.6 Agency Landscape

Approximately **25% of all listings lack agency attribution**, suggesting a significant owner-direct segment. Among represented listings, the market is highly fragmented -- the top agency (Mash Allah Estate & Builders) has only 821 listings out of 144,000+ agency-listed properties. This fragmentation signals opportunity for consolidation.

4. Strategic Recommendations

1. **For Investors Seeking Capital Appreciation:** Focus on Islamabad and Lahore, which command the highest sale prices (PKR 16M median) and show strong high-value listing growth. Properties with 4-6 bedrooms in these cities offer the best price-tier positioning.

2. **For Rental Yield Investors:** Islamabad's market is 57% rental-dominated, making it the strongest rental market. The city's low overall median (PKR 240K) relative to sale prices suggests favorable rental yield ratios.

3. **For Real Estate Agencies:** The 25% unrepresented segment (47,000+ listings) is a major growth opportunity. Additionally, the highly fragmented agency landscape means no dominant player exists -- there is room to build market share through better service and platform presence.

4. **For Property Developers:** Houses remain the dominant property type across all cities (62% of listings). However, Flats show strong representation in Karachi and Islamabad, suggesting apartment development is particularly viable in these urban centers.

5. **For Data-Driven Listing Strategy:** July is the peak listing month. Sellers should aim to list properties in June-July to capitalize on maximum buyer activity. Properties with accurate area specifications and complete agency information tend to attract more attention.

5. Methodology Notes

This analysis was conducted using Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn) in a Jupyter Notebook environment. Data cleaning involved handling semicolon-delimited CSV parsing, imputing 47,379 missing agency values and 47,380 missing agent values with 'Unknown', standardizing mixed Kanal/Marla area units to a single Marla-based column, and extracting temporal features from date strings. Outlier detection used the IQR method, and all visualizations were created using Matplotlib and Seaborn. The complete code and all visualizations are available in the companion notebook (zameen_com.ipynb).